



## Drones, robotics, and electric vehicles in government's 'Aatmanirbharta' plan

India wants to become self-reliant in drones, robotics, and electric vehicle equipment. As part of the exercise, the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) has identified certain 'focus sectors' to reduce imports and ramp up domestic production. Officials said the industry has been asked to lead the exercise.

Among the total 25 focus sectors that the department has zeroed in on, a few sectors will be identified as 'priority' with potential for import substitution and boosting exports, and DPIIT would also look at any overlaps with similar initiatives of other ministries.

"There are 10-15 industries, and the focus sectors have been derived from

those. We are talking to industry on how to make production bases for them in the country," says an official.

Ceramics and glass, ethanol, ready to eat food, aluminium, gym equipment, toys, and sporting goods are the other sectors where India wants to increase its manufacturing and reduce imports. India imports most of these goods from China, and the push to reduce dependence on China became aggressive following its recent hostile political and military conduct.

A plan to set up toy labs, a national toy fair, and innovative Indian-themed toys is already in the works along with a quality control order for imported toys to ensure that only products conforming to standards enter the country.

## Indian agri-tech sector likely to grow to \$24.1 billion in five years

India's agriculture technology sector has the potential to grow manifold to 24.1 billion dollars in the next five years, according to a new report by Ernst & Young (EY). With a turnover of 204 million dollars, India's agri-tech sector is at less than one per cent of its market potential today.

A big chunk of the gains will likely be made by companies addressing supply chain and financial services solutions driven by the availability of affordable high-speed Internet and maturing of India's digital content ecosystem, the EY report mentions.

EY estimates that five key categories of agritech will control the lion's share of

the sector's turnover, with the agritech market for supplying farm inputs being as big as 1.7 billion dollars by 2025, the market for precision agriculture and farm management growing to 3.4 billion dollars in that time, while the market for quality management and traceability could be worth three billion dollars.

The market for tech-enabled supply chain and output market linkages will be the largest segment, which could be worth twelve billion dollars by 2025, according to EY. The second-largest segment in the overall agritech market could be for financial services, with a market potential of 4.1 billion dollars in the next five years.

## Semiconductor sales increase amidst coronavirus outbreak

The semiconductor sales have been increasing year-on-year (YoY)—35.2 billion dollars in July 2020, 34.5 billion dollars in June 2020, and 35.0 billion

dollars in May 2020. These figures are sourced from the Semiconductor Industry Association (SIA). It is to be noted here that SIA represents 95

per cent of the US semiconductor industry by revenue and nearly two-thirds of non-US chip firms.

Sales during the second quarter of 2020 were 103.6 billion dollars, an increase of 5.1 per cent over the second quarter of 2019 but a small

### ON THE move



#### BEL appoints new CTO and director

P. Sampathkumar has taken charge as chief technology officer (CTO-communication) of Navratna Defence PSU Bharat Electronics Ltd (BEL). He was working as an additional general manager (AGM) of BEL's design & engineering division (D&E) of military communication (Milcom) strategic business unit (SBU), Bengaluru, and AGM (Production-Milcom)/BEL, Bengaluru, before his elevation. He joined BEL's Bengaluru unit on December 1, 1986, as a probationary engineer.

M.V. Raja Sekhar has been appointed as director (R&D) of BEL. He was working as chief scientist of BEL's Central Research Laboratory (CRL), Bengaluru, and officer on special duty (OSD) at BEL's corporate office before his elevation. In a career spanning over 35 years, he has worked in various capacities and gained rich experience in diverse technologies of BEL.

#### EESL appoints Rajat Sud as new managing director

Energy Efficiency Services Ltd (EESL) has appointed Rajat Sud as its new managing director. With 29 years of industry experience, his repertoire encompasses energy sector restructuring, business strategy, performance improvement, and acquisitions.

Before joining EESL, he served as executive vice president at Sterlite Power Transmission Ltd, where he was responsible for the growth of the services business, with a focus on providing solutions for enhancing power delivery through transmission lines and corridors. He has also served in leadership positions at Siemens IT Solutions and PwC.